FREE RESOURCE

THE LOCAL SEO CHECKLIST

The 43 things every local business needs in place to show up in the map pack, organic results, and AI answers. Check them off as you go.

GOOGLE BUSINESS PROFILE

- [ ] Claim and verify your Google Business Profile.
- [ ] Pick the most accurate primary category, then add every secondary category that truly fits.
- [ ] Match your business name to your real-world signage. No keyword stuffing.
- [ ] Set accurate hours, including holiday hours.
- [ ] Fill out every service and product with clear descriptions.
- [ ] Upload real photos of your work, team, and location, and keep adding new ones.
- [ ] Post updates, offers, or news on a regular schedule.
- [ ] Answer questions in the Q&A section before someone else does.

NAP AND CITATIONS

- [ ] Use one exact version of your name, address, and phone number (NAP) everywhere.
- [ ] Put your NAP in the footer of every page on your site.
- [ ] Get listed on the major directories and data aggregators.
- [ ] Claim listings on the directories specific to your industry.
- [ ] Find and fix duplicate or outdated listings.

WEBSITE AND ON-PAGE

- [ ] Give every core service its own page. Do not cram them onto one page.
- [ ] Build a location page for each city you serve, with real local details, not swapped city names.
- [ ] Write a unique title tag for every page with the service and city near the front.
- [ ] Use one clear main heading per page that says what the page is about.
- [ ] Embed a Google Map on your contact or location page.
- [ ] Make your phone number tap-to-call on mobile.
- [ ] Put a clear call to action above the fold on every key page.

TECHNICAL FOUNDATION

- [ ] Serve the whole site over HTTPS.
- [ ] Make sure the site works well and loads fast on phones.
- [ ] Check Core Web Vitals in Google Search Console and fix what is red.
- [ ] Submit an XML sitemap to Google Search Console and Bing Webmaster Tools.
- [ ] Check that robots.txt is not blocking pages you want found.
- [ ] Add LocalBusiness schema with your NAP, hours, and service area, and validate it.
- [ ] Fix broken links and redirect old URLs.

REVIEWS

- [ ] Make asking for a review part of every finished job.
- [ ] Send customers a direct link to your review form.
- [ ] Reply to every review, good and bad, in a professional tone.

- [ ] Encourage customers to mention the service they got and where.
- [ ] Never buy reviews or offer incentives for them.

CONTENT AND LOCAL LINKS

- [ ] Answer the real questions customers ask you, one clear answer per question.
- [ ] Show proof: project photos, case studies, and customer stories.
- [ ] Earn links from local organizations, sponsorships, chambers, and partners.
- [ ] Get mentioned in local news and community sites.
- [ ] Link related pages on your own site together.

AI SEARCH READINESS

- [ ] Lead each page with a direct answer, then explain.
- [ ] Add FAQ sections with FAQPage schema where they fit.
- [ ] Keep your business details identical across your site, profiles, and directories so AI tools trust them.
- [ ] Link your site and profiles together with sameAs in your schema.
- [ ] Publish an llms.txt file that tells AI tools who you are and what to cite.
- [ ] Ask ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Google's AI Mode about your business and check what they say.